THE AGED LEAD OPERATOR'S SYSTEM

The Home Services Edition

The complete operator's manual for turning aged home services leads into closed deals — scripts, unit economics, cadence, nurture, and compliance.

8×

typical ROI at 15% contact × 6% sold on aged roofing leads

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Not legal advice · Consult TCPA-literate counsel before running outreach

The Aged Lead Operator's System

The complete playbook for turning cheap leads into closed deals.

By Bill Rice — Founder, Work Aged Leads

A note on how to use this playbook

Aged-lead operations run on three compliance modes. Pick the one that matches your risk appetite and your counsel's advice.

Mode A — Conservative. Manual dialing only. SMS only to leads where you have captured fresh consent *directly from the prospect* (not inherited from a publisher). No predictive or parallel dialing, no ringless voicemail. Every touch logged with consent record. The legal floor. Slower velocity, lowest exposure. **Most small shops should start here.**

Mode B — Operator Standard. Manual or preview (one-at-a-time, agent-initiated) dialing. SMS only to leads with clear documented consent that permits SMS from your company. Rigorous DNC scrub, documented opt-out honoring, 10DLC registration. Quarterly compliance audit. What most compliant growth-oriented operators run.

Mode C — Not Recommended. Predictive or parallel dialing to cell phones, ringless voicemail at scale, SMS to aged lists without verified consent, ignoring state mini-TCPA frequency caps. High plaintiff's-firm exposure and regulatory risk. **This playbook does not teach these tactics.**

Default recommendation: start in Mode A. Use the scripts and cadence in this playbook to re-contact aged leads via manual dial and email. Use the "Fresh-Consent Ladder" techniques (Part IV) to *earn fresh SMS and automation consent directly from each prospect* — then you can graduate those specific prospects to Mode B outreach cleanly.

Recommended counsel. If you need a TCPA/compliance attorney, the firm I trust is Henson Legal. They're who I call when I have a real question.

This playbook is operator guidance, not legal advice. TCPA, FCC rules, and state mini-TCPA laws change frequently, and consent requirements vary by state and by consent record. Before running outreach against any list, consult counsel familiar with TCPA and your state's rules. For regulated verticals (mortgage, insurance, Medicare), also consult the applicable CFPB, CMS, DOI, and state-licensing guidance.

Who this is for

You bought aged leads before. Maybe they worked. Maybe they didn't. Either way, something told you there's more to extract from them — and you were right.

This playbook is for the sales professional or small team who is done guessing. You want a system that turns a cold file of 30-, 60-, or 180-day-old leads into predictable, trackable pipeline. You want scripts that don't sound like a call center. You want to know — down to the unit — what it costs to close one.

You don't need theory. You need a playbook you can run on Monday morning.

What's inside

1. **Part I — The Operator's Mindset.** Why aged leads still convert, why most people fail at them, and the three beliefs you need before you pick up the phone.
2. **Part II — The Unit Economics.** The five numbers that decide whether aged leads make or lose you money, and how to calculate your break-even on any list.
3. **Part III — Setting Up Your Operation.** The tech stack spectrum from no-tech to full-tech, and the minimum viable setup for each level.
4. **Part IV — The Outreach Framework.** A day-by-day, channel-by-channel cadence. Scripts included. Rules of engagement for phone, SMS, email, and voicemail.
5. **Part V — The Infinity Nurture System.** How to turn an aged-lead database into a long-term asset that produces closes for years.
6. **Part VI — Compliance Foundation.** TCPA, state DNC, consent documentation, suppression lists. The rules that keep you in business.
7. **Part VII — The 90-Day Operator Diagnostic.** A self-scoring assessment to see exactly where your operation is strong and where it's leaking money.

Your **workbook** is the companion to this playbook. It has 10 worksheets that turn every framework here into a filled-out artifact for your business. Work the playbook and the workbook together.

Part I — The Operator's Mindset

Why aged leads still convert

Aged leads are consumer inquiries — mortgage, insurance, home services, whatever vertical you work — that were generated 30, 60, 90, or 180+ days ago. They filled out a form or made a call. They got worked by the original buyer. Then they went into a file and got re-sold at a steep discount.

The conventional wisdom is that they're "dead." That's wrong, and it's wrong for a specific, measurable reason: **consumer intent doesn't evaporate on a schedule that matches a call center's patience.**

A homeowner who asked about refinancing in January didn't stop needing money in February. A small business owner who requested insurance quotes in March didn't magically find coverage in April. What changed is that the agent on the other end called them three times, got voicemail, and quit.

The aged-leads opportunity is arbitrage on sales-team attention span.

The data supports this. Across the aged-leads industry, a well-run campaign will produce:

- **12–18% contact rate** over a multi-touch, multi-channel cadence
- **1–5% contact-to-close** conversion rate, depending on vertical and skill
- **$5–$25 cost per contact** at typical aged-lead prices
- **$50–$500+ cost per close** depending on deal size and vertical

Run those numbers against a $300 commission or a $5,000 loan margin, and you have a business. Run them against a $50 final-expense premium or a $150 roofing lead, and you have a business. The numbers work in almost every vertical — if, and only if, you run them like an operator.

Why most people fail at aged leads

I've watched hundreds of buyers try aged leads. The ones who fail have one of four problems:

1. **They treat aged like fresh.** They expect the same answer-rate as a lead generated 30 seconds ago. When they don't get it, they quit.

2. **They don't have a cadence.** They call once, maybe leave a voicemail, maybe send a text, and move on. Aged leads reward persistence. Single-touch aged is a waste of money.
3. **They skip the math.** They don't know their cost-per-contact, so they don't know if they're winning or losing. They judge by feel. Feel is a liar.
4. **They cut compliance corners.** They skip DNC scrubbing, they text without consent, they get a cease-and-desist, they panic, they quit the channel. Compliance isn't a tax — it's a moat.

All four problems are solvable. That's what this playbook fixes.

> **Where to buy the leads in this playbook.**
>
> Before you read further: you'll need actual aged leads to run this system. One of the largest aged-data marketplaces in the industry is **AgedLeadStore** — vertical-specific lists, verified and hygiene-screened contact data, and filter by age/geo/demographics.
>
> **Browse all lead types at agedleadstore.com →**

The three beliefs you need

Before we get into tactics, adopt these three beliefs. If you can't get behind them, close this file and ask for a refund.

Belief 1: Volume beats velocity.

Fresh-lead sales is a velocity game. Aged-lead sales is a volume game. You are not trying to convert every lead as fast as possible. You are trying to touch the largest number of leads enough times to surface the ones who still have intent. A 1% close rate on 2,000 leads is 20 deals. A 5% close rate on 100 leads is 5 deals. The 2,000-lead operator wins.

Belief 2: The follow-up is the product.

Your product isn't the call. Your product isn't the quote. Your product is a **sustained, professional presence** in the prospect's inbox, phone, and calendar over a 30-, 60-, 90-day window. If you show up on Day 1 and quit on Day 3, you are not running aged leads. You are running a lottery.

Belief 3: Compliance is a weapon, not a cost.

Every competitor who skips DNC, ignores state consent laws, or fires off blind autodialed SMS is going to get shut down. You get to eat their leads, their prospects, and their market share — on the

one condition that you stay clean. Compliance is not a tax you pay to lawyers. It is the floor that lets you build higher than the operators who chose shortcuts.

Part II — The Unit Economics

Every aged-lead operation lives or dies by five numbers. Most people know two of them. The winners know all five and track them weekly.

The five numbers

1. Cost Per Lead (CPL)

What you paid to acquire the lead file. Aged leads typically run:

Age	Vertical avg CPL
30–60 days	$3–$10
61–90 days	$1–$5
91–180 days	$0.50–$2
181+ days	$0.25–$1

Prices vary by vertical (final-expense is cheaper than refi, solar is pricier than auto insurance) and by exclusivity (non-exclusive is cheaper than exclusive).

2. Contact Rate

The percentage of leads you actually reach (human answering the phone, replying to text, or replying to email). Industry benchmarks for a well-run, multi-touch, 7–14-day cadence:

Data age	Realistic contact rate
30–60 days	18–25%
61–90 days	14–20%
91–180 days	10–16%
181+ days	6–12%

If you're hitting the low end, your phone numbers are old, your cadence is thin, or your channel mix is wrong. The playbook fixes all three.

3. Contact-to-Close Rate

Of the contacts you reach, what percentage turn into a sale, application, or booked job. This is the number that's most under your control. Typical ranges:

Vertical	Contact-to-close
Mortgage (refi/purchase)	2–6%
Final expense	8–15%
Auto insurance	3–8%
Home services	5–12%
Solar	2–5%
Medicare	4–10%

Your scripts, your product, your price, and your pipeline follow-up all move this number.

4. Average Revenue Per Close (ARPC)

What you earn per closed deal. Commission, override, net margin — whatever flows to you personally or your business.

5. Cost Per Close (CPC)

This is the output number. It's the ratio that decides if the operation makes money.

```
CPC = CPL ÷ (Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close Rate)
```

If your CPL is $2, your contact rate is 15%, and your contact-to-close is 4%:

```
CPC = $2 ÷ (0.15 × 0.04) = $2 ÷ 0.006 = $333
```

You are paying $333 in lead cost for every closed deal. If your ARPC is $1,200, you have a $867 gross contribution per close. If your ARPC is $300, you're losing $33 every time you win — and the operation is upside-down.

The break-even math

Your break-even ARPC is the ARPC you *must* hit to cover your CPC.

```
Break-even ARPC = CPL ÷ (Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close Rate)
```

That's literally the same formula as CPC. Your break-even ARPC is your CPC.

If your ARPC is below your CPC, you have two options: reduce CPL (buy older or larger batches), or raise contact rate and contact-to-close (better cadence, better scripts). This playbook gives you both levers.

The profitability gate

Before you buy a single lead, run the pre-flight check:

1. **What's your ARPC?** Be honest. Use the average of your last 10 closes, not your best one.
2. **What's your realistic contact rate?** If you're new to aged, assume 12%. If you've run a few batches, use your actual number.
3. **What's your realistic contact-to-close?** If you're new to aged, assume 2%. If you've run a few batches, use your actual number.
4. **Compute max viable CPL:** `Max CPL = ARPC × 0.25 × Contact Rate × Contact-to-Close`

The `× 0.25` gives you a 4× return on lead spend. That's the minimum you want — it covers labor, overhead, and leaves margin. If you want a 5× return, use `× 0.20`. If you want to break even, use `× 1.00`.

Example. You sell auto insurance with an ARPC of $250. You target a 4× return. You estimate 15% contact rate, 5% contact-to-close.

```
Max CPL = $250 × 0.25 × 0.15 × 0.05 = $0.47
```

You should not pay more than $0.47 per lead. If someone is selling you aged auto-insurance leads at $3, they are selling you a losing operation no matter how good your scripts are.

This one calculation, done before purchase, filters out 80% of the bad deals in the aged-leads market.

Worksheet 1 — Unit Economics. In your companion workbook, fill out the unit-economics worksheet with your actual numbers. It takes 10 minutes. Do not skip it.

Part III — Setting Up Your Operation

You don't need a $50K tech stack to run aged leads. You don't even need a CRM. What you need is a system — a defined flow from lead arrival to close, with an owner for each step.

This section lays out three setups: no-tech, light-tech, and full-tech. Pick the one that matches your volume and scale up only when you hit a bottleneck.

The three setups

Setup A: No-tech (1 rep, 0–500 leads/month)

You can run this with a phone, a cheap SMS service, and a spreadsheet. You will not scale past 500 leads per month, but you will have a working operation inside of a week.

Required:

- Dialer: any business phone line, VoIP preferred (Google Voice, OpenPhone, $15/mo)
- SMS: compliant texting tool ($20–$50/mo — TextMagic, Textline, SimpleTexting)
- Email: Gmail/Outlook + a free tracking extension (Mailtrack)
- DNC scrubber: DNC.com, PossibleNOW, or NCOA + DNC tool ($50–$200 per scrub)
- CRM: **None.** Use a Google Sheet with columns for lead source, date purchased, phone, email, last-touch date, status, notes, next-action date.

What you give up: dialer analytics, automated cadence, call recording for QA, reporting beyond what you can calculate in the sheet.

What you keep: 100% of your margin and a working operation.

Setup B: Light-tech (1–5 reps, 500–5,000 leads/month)

You've outgrown the sheet. You're missing follow-ups. You're losing track of what you said to whom. You need infrastructure.

Required:

- Dialer: a business phone system with call recording ($50–$100/user/month — Kixie, Aircall, RingCentral)

- SMS: integrated with the CRM ($0.01–$0.03 per message typically bundled with the CRM)
- Email: business inbox integrated with the CRM
- DNC scrubber: integrated or batch ($100–$500/month at volume)
- CRM: a real CRM with cadence automation (HubSpot, Close, Zoho, GoHighLevel — $50–$150/user/month)
- **Preview dialer only** — agent sees the record and initiates each call one-at-a-time ($75–$150/user/month — PhoneBurner preview mode, Kixie PowerList preview mode). **Do not use parallel or predictive dialing modes on aged cell-phone leads.** The TCPA consent picture on inherited aged-lead consent rarely supports auto-initiated dialing to cell phones without exposure; predictive/parallel dialers are a Mode C tactic in this context.

What you gain: cadence automation (touches fire automatically per your rules), call recording for training and QA, pipeline visibility, contact-rate tracking per list source so you can buy smarter.

Total cost (1 rep): $200–$400/month. At 1,000 leads/month, that's $0.20–$0.40 added cost per lead — meaningful, but usually recovered 5× over in productivity gains.

Setup C: Full-tech (5+ reps, 5,000+ leads/month)

You're running a real floor. You need scale, predictability, and training infrastructure.

Required everything above, plus:

- AI-assisted dialer / omni-channel platform (Convoso, Five9, Balto, $100–$200/user/month) — **still run in preview mode by default.** Predictive modes are only appropriate if your consent workflow produces fresh PEWC from each prospect before the call (see Fresh-Consent Ladder, Part IV).
- Real-time QA and coaching (Gong, Chorus, Balto AI coaching)
- Inbound call handling for callbacks (dedicated DID pool, skill-based routing)
- Business intelligence layer (Tableau, PowerBI, or custom — $200+/month)
- Compliance automation — TCPA consent capture (inbound opt-ins logged with timestamp/IP), DNC scrub automation, suppression file automation, cross-channel opt-out propagation. At this tier this should be a named system, not an afterthought.

Total cost: $500–$1,200/user/month. This tier is only worth it when you can keep 5+ reps dialing full-time. Below that, you are paying for capacity you aren't using.

Picking your tier — the decision rule

- **Under 500 leads/month and under $5K in gross profit from aged:** stay on Setup A. The tech cost will eat your margin.
- **500–5,000 leads/month and $5K–$30K/month gross profit:** move to Setup B. The automation will more than pay for itself in missed follow-ups recovered.
- **5,000+ leads/month and 3+ full-time reps:** move to Setup C only when the bottleneck is team throughput, not lead quality or scripts.

The two most common mistakes:

1. **Buying Setup C when you only need Setup A.** You spend $5,000/month on tech and your single rep uses 10% of it. The tech is an identity purchase, not a productivity purchase.
2. **Staying on Setup A when you need Setup B.** You have 3 reps sharing a spreadsheet, missing 40% of follow-ups, and you can't explain why your contact rate is terrible. You're saving $400/month in tech and losing $4,000/month in uncalled prospects.

> **Worksheet 2 — Tech Stack Decision.** In your workbook, walk through the decision rule with your current volume and team size. Write down your tier and a 90-day upgrade trigger.

Operational roles (even if one person wears all the hats)

No matter which tier you run, five roles must exist. One person can wear all five — but if any role is missing, the operation leaks.

1. **Buyer.** Sources lead files, negotiates pricing, owns quality tracking per source.
2. **Scrubber.** Runs DNC, state DNC, suppression, and data-hygiene steps before any outreach fires.
3. **Opener.** Runs first-touch outreach (day 0–2), qualifies intent.
4. **Closer.** Handles the quote, application, or sale. May be the same person as opener.
5. **Nurturer.** Owns the 30-, 60-, 90-, 180-day follow-up of everyone who didn't close immediately.

In Setup A, you are all five. That's fine — but block your calendar so each role gets dedicated time. One hour of buying, one hour of scrubbing, four hours of opening, two hours of closing, one hour of nurture, every day. Do not blend them.

Part IV — The Outreach Framework

This is the core of the playbook. Everything else supports this.

The principles

Before the cadence, the principles. Break these and the cadence won't save you.

1. **Multi-channel beats multi-touch on one channel.** Five phone calls is a worse strategy than two phone calls + one voicemail + one SMS + one email. Channels unlock channels.
2. **Different times, different days.** Rotate call times. A prospect who doesn't answer at 10 AM Monday might answer at 6 PM Thursday. Same with SMS send times.
3. **Value in every touch.** Every message — call, voicemail, SMS, email — gives the prospect a reason to respond. Not "just checking in." Ever.
4. **Escalate, then de-escalate.** Front-load intensity in the first 7 days. Taper to weekly, then monthly. Never go to zero.
5. **Document everything.** Every touch logged with outcome. If you can't see the touch history at a glance, the next touch is guessing.

The 14-day opener cadence

This is the cadence for a newly-acquired aged lead, whether it's 30 days old or 180 days old. Run this for every lead. The worksheet in your workbook has a fillable version.

Day 0 (purchase day)

- **Scrub.** Run DNC. Remove suppressed numbers. Remove any state-regulated numbers your licensing doesn't cover.
- **Segment.** Tag by age, source, vertical, and any demographic signal the file provides (geo, age bracket, estimated income).
- **No outreach today.** Give the data 24 hours to finish processing.

Day 1

- **Phone call #1** — morning hours (9–11 AM prospect local time). Use Script A1 (see Part IV scripts).
- If no answer: **voicemail** — 15-second message, value-first, no pressure.
- **SMS #1** — within 15 minutes of the voicemail, referencing the call. "Hey [Name] — Bill with [Company] — just tried you. Quick question on your [vertical] inquiry. Good to grab 2 minutes this week?"

Day 2

- **Email #1** — sent morning. Subject: "Your [vertical] request from [month]." Body: 4–6 lines. Acknowledge the age of the inquiry, offer a specific value point, ask for a time.

Day 3

- **Phone call #2** — different time of day than Day 1 (try afternoon, 2–5 PM local).
- Voicemail only if Call #2 lands on a different day of week than Call #1's voicemail.
- **SMS #2** — value-focused, not follow-up focused. Example: "Hey [Name] — one thing a lot of folks in your situation don't know: [insert value nugget]. Worth a 5-min call?"

Day 5

- **Phone call #3** — third different time (try evening, 5–7 PM local, where compliance allows).
- **Email #2** — different angle. Not "just following up." Case study, stat, or a specific question.

Day 7

- **Phone call #4** — morning, different day of week than all previous.
- **SMS #3** — "break-up" style. "Hey [Name] — I've reached out a couple times on your [vertical] inquiry. If the timing's off, just reply STOP and I'll take you off my list. Otherwise, happy to help when you're ready."

Day 10

- **Email #3** — break-up email. Short. "Closing your file unless I hear back."

Day 14

- **Phone call #5** — final opener-cadence touch. If no contact, move the lead to **nurture** (Part V).

Contact outcomes

If at any point the prospect replies, answers, or otherwise engages: exit the opener cadence, run the qualifying call, and begin the appropriate sales sequence. Do not keep running opener touches on a live prospect.

If at any point the prospect says "stop," "remove me," "not interested," or any cease language: stop all outreach, tag the lead with a suppression flag, add to your internal DNC, and do not touch again.

The phone scripts

Script A1 — First-touch call (live pickup)

> "Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. About [time period] back you asked about [vertical] — is that still something you're exploring, or did you get that handled already?"

Shut up. Wait for the answer. Three outcomes:

- **"Got it handled."** Probe: "Gotcha — totally fine. Mind if I ask what you ended up doing? Just curious, since it'll help me be more useful to folks in a similar spot." Often the answer is "I didn't actually do anything" — and the conversation starts.
- **"Still looking."** Go directly to qualification: "Awesome — quick question: what's the most important thing for you right now on the [vertical] side?" Then run your normal qualifying call.
- **"Who is this, how'd you get my info?"** Direct, calm: "Totally fair question. You filled out a form about [vertical] on [month]. I bought that list from the publisher — that's where your info came from. Happy to take you off my list if the timing's wrong." This kills adversarial energy.

Script A2 — Voicemail (first-touch)

Keep it under 15 seconds. Three elements: who, what, next step.

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Calling about the [vertical] thing you looked at a couple months back. Wanted to see if you still needed help or if you're all set. Give me a ring back at [number] or I'll try you in a couple days."

No urgency, no fake urgency. Aged prospects have been called by 20 people who faked urgency. Calmness cuts through.

Script A3 — Day 3 follow-up call (live pickup)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] again with [Company]. Left you a message the other day on your [vertical] question — did that make sense, or do you want me to catch you up on it?"

This script assumes they heard the first voicemail. Most didn't. That's fine — the "did that make sense" framing lets them ask what you're calling about without feeling rude.

Script A4 — Break-up call (Day 7 or Day 14)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. I've tried you a few times on your [vertical] inquiry — I'll stop calling after today. If it's just bad timing, no problem, give me a ring when you're ready. My number's [number]. Have a good one."

The break-up pattern works because it removes pressure. Prospects who were avoiding because they thought they'd have to say no now have permission to call back without committing. You'll get a 5–15% callback rate on break-ups when they're done calmly.

The SMS scripts

SMS is the highest-ROI channel in aged-lead outreach when used correctly. It is also the fastest way to lose your operation if you don't get consent and compliance right.

Before sending any SMS, verify:

- The lead's original form had SMS/text consent language
- Your outbound number is registered (for US, this means 10DLC registration with your carrier)
- You're not texting a number on DNC
- Your message includes opt-out language on the first touch ("Reply STOP to unsubscribe")

Script S1 — Post-voicemail SMS

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company] — just left you a voicemail about your [vertical] question from [month]. Got 2 minutes sometime this week? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script S2 — Value-first SMS

> "Hey [Name] — quick thing on [vertical]: [one-sentence value point specific to vertical]. If useful, happy to walk you through it in a 5-min call. Reply STOP to opt out."

Example value points:

- Mortgage: "rates on 30-year fixed dropped ~0.4% this quarter — may be worth a quick look at your numbers"
- Insurance: "most folks I talk to who shopped 3+ months ago are overpaying 15–30% on their current policy"
- Home services: "I'm in your area next week — can do a 15-min no-pressure estimate if you're still thinking about it"

Script S3 — Break-up SMS

> "Hey [Name] — reached out a couple times on your [vertical] question. If the timing's off I'll back off. Reply back if you want to pick it up — otherwise I'll close out my notes. Reply STOP to opt out."

The email scripts

Email is the lowest-intensity channel and the best for long nurture. Opener emails should be short, text-only, and human-toned. No HTML templates. No logos. No "this email was sent by [marketing tool]."

Script E1 — Day 2 opener email

Subject: Your [vertical] request from [month]

Hey [Name],

Bill here — a few months back, you asked about [vertical] through [source form / publisher name, if you can get it]. I just bought that inquiry list, so your name landed on my desk.

Quick question: did you end up getting that handled, or is it still open?

If it's still open, I can probably save you some time. If it's handled, no worries — just say "handled" and I'll close it out.

— Bill [phone number] [reply-to email]

Script E2 — Day 5 value email

Subject: [One specific question about vertical]

[Name] —

One thing I see a lot with folks who shopped [vertical] a few months back: [specific pattern or mistake common in that vertical].

If that sounds familiar, I can walk through what's changed in the market since then in about 5 minutes. No pitch — just a quick pulse check.

Want me to send a calendar link, or easier to grab a quick call?

— Bill

Script E3 — Day 10 break-up email

Subject: Closing your file

[Name] —

I'll stop reaching out after this one. If you want to pick up the [vertical] conversation, just reply here and I'll jump back in. Otherwise, I'll assume the timing's off and close your file on my side.

— Bill

Break-up emails get the highest reply rate of any email in the cadence. Plan for it.

The Fresh-Consent Ladder

Here's the most important operational shift in modern aged-lead work: **your long-term operation shouldn't run on inherited consent at all. It should run on fresh consent that you captured directly from each prospect.**

Inherited consent — the signature the prospect gave a publisher 90 or 180 days ago — is legally murky and getting murkier. Fresh consent — the opt-in you capture from the prospect *today*, naming your company, specifying the channel, with a timestamp and IP — is clean, defensible, and stacks up as an asset over time.

The ladder works like this: use the aged-lead cadence (manual calls, human voicemails, plain-text emails) to **re-open the conversation.** Then, at every moment where the prospect engages, **earn fresh consent** before escalating channels or frequency.

Play 1 — The callback-page opt-in

Every voicemail and email in your cadence sends the prospect to a dedicated landing page (your domain, not the publisher's) that restates the conversation and offers value. The page has a short form: name, phone, email, and an explicit checkbox: *"Yes — please call, text, or email me about my [vertical] question. I understand this consent is given to [Your Company Name]."* Submission logs timestamp, IP, and consent language.

Now that prospect is on your PEWC record. Everything after that — SMS, calendar links, follow-up calls — runs on consent *you captured,* not consent you inherited.

Play 2 — The text-to-join keyword

Build a dedicated SMS keyword: *"Text INFO to [short code or 10DLC number] for a free quote / update / estimate."* Mention it in every voicemail, every email footer, every website page. When the prospect texts in, the reply includes your PEWC disclosure and asks them to confirm: *"Reply YES to continue receiving updates from [Company]. Msg & data rates apply. Reply STOP to cancel."*

When they reply YES, you have fresh, text-initiated, PEWC-compliant SMS consent from the prospect themselves.

Play 3 — The qualifying-call consent ask

At the end of every live qualifying call, before you hang up, ask:

> "Before I let you go — so I can stay in touch as [rates move / your claim progresses / spots open up], can I have your permission to text you? You can reply STOP any time."

Document their verbal yes in the call recording (if you record) or in your CRM note with date/time. This is fresh verbal consent, and in most jurisdictions it supports follow-up SMS and calls from that point forward. Some operators follow this with a quick confirmation text the prospect must reply to — belt and suspenders.

Play 4 — The quote/estimate checkbox

Any time you deliver a quote (mortgage rate quote, insurance illustration, home-services estimate), include a checkbox on the delivery email or form: *"Yes — please text me updates about this [quote / policy / project]."* This is the highest-quality consent you can capture, because the prospect is already deep in the sales funnel.

Play 5 — The nurture re-engagement button

Every newsletter or nurture email to your aged-lead list includes a CTA: *"Still want updates? [Confirm here]"* Prospects who click affirm ongoing consent; prospects who don't silently downgrade to Dormant. Over 6–12 months of nurture, this produces a clean re-consented list that's yours.

Play 6 — The incentive opt-in

Offer something worth opting in for: a market report, a free consultation, a calculator result, a sample estimate. The prospect gives you fresh PEWC in exchange for the resource. You now have permission plus a reason they remember you.

The operational consequence

Once you run the Fresh-Consent Ladder for 60–90 days, your outreach list splits into two tiers:

1. **Tier 1 — Fresh Consent.** Prospects who came back to you and opted in directly. You can run SMS, automation, and broader outreach to them (respecting all legal caps). Treat like a customer list.
2. **Tier 2 — Inherited Consent Only.** Prospects who haven't re-engaged. Mode A outreach only — manual dial, plain-text email, voicemail. No SMS, no automation, no RVM.

The goal of every aged-lead campaign is to move prospects from Tier 2 to Tier 1. The system isn't "work aged leads forever." The system is **convert purchased prospects into owned prospects.**

Worksheet 5 addendum. In your workbook, note which Fresh-Consent Ladder play you'll build first. Start with Play 1 (callback-page opt-in) — it's the highest-leverage one.

You now have the scripts. Get the leads.

The scripts above work on aged leads across mortgage, insurance, solar, home services, Medicare, and more. The hard part isn't the cadence — it's getting a high-quality, consent-documented source to run them against.

AgedLeadStore sells in every one of these verticals, with batches as small as 100 leads so you can test before scaling.

See all aged lead types →

Part V — The Infinity Nurture System

The opener cadence handles the first 14 days. After that, 85–90% of your leads will have not closed. They are not dead — they are **not yet**. Your job is to stay professionally present until they are ready.

This is where most aged-lead operations die. They buy a new list, blow through the opener cadence, and abandon the 85% who didn't close. Then they buy another list.

The math of that is brutal. If you buy 1,000 leads/month and abandon 90% after 14 days, you accumulate zero long-term asset. If you buy 1,000 leads/month and nurture the 90%, after 12 months you have a nurture list of 10,800 prospects — all of whom raised their hand for your product at some point.

A 1% annual close rate on a nurture list of 10,800 is 108 deals, at near-zero marginal cost. That's your second business.

The nurture architecture

After Day 14 (end of opener cadence), every non-closed lead enters one of three buckets:

Bucket 1: Warm — active follow-up, 30-day rhythm

Qualification: Any lead that responded to the opener cadence but didn't close. Includes "call me next month," "I'm thinking about it," "reach out in Q2."

Cadence:

- Week 3 after opener: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Week 5: 1 phone call + 1 email
- Week 7: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Continue at 2-week rhythm for 3 months

Exit criteria:

- Closes: move to customer list
- Opts out: move to suppression

- Goes completely silent for 90 days: demote to Cold (Bucket 2)

Bucket 2: Cold — passive nurture, 90-day rhythm

Qualification: Any lead that didn't respond to the opener cadence and didn't opt out.

Cadence:

- Month 1 after opener: 1 email — "Still thinking about [vertical]?" — soft, no pressure
- Month 3: 1 phone call + 1 email
- Month 6: 1 phone call + 1 text
- Month 9: 1 email with a market update
- Month 12: 1 phone call — "anniversary" call

Exit criteria:

- Responds to any touch: promote to Warm
- Opts out: move to suppression
- No response after 12 months: demote to Dormant (Bucket 3) OR drop entirely

Bucket 3: Dormant — newsletter only

Qualification: Leads that have been through 12+ months of nurture without a response, but haven't opted out.

Cadence:

- Monthly email newsletter — market updates, relevant tips, no direct sell
- No phone calls
- No SMS (SMS consent degrades after long silence — compliance risk)

Exit criteria:

- Unsubscribes: suppression
- Opens/clicks newsletter: promote to Cold
- Replies to newsletter: promote to Warm

The nurture calendar (simplified)

Map every lead to one of these three buckets on Day 14. Then let the calendar run.

Day	Warm	Cold	Dormant
14	Enter bucket	Enter bucket	—
30	Call + text	—	—
45	Call + email	Email (Month 1)	—
60	Call + text	—	—
90	Call + text	Call + email (Month 3)	—
180	Continue 2-wk	Call + text (Month 6)	—
270	—	Email (Month 9)	—
365	—	Anniversary call (Month 12)	Enter bucket / drop
Monthly	—	—	Newsletter

A CRM with cadence automation (Setup B+) makes this effortless. In Setup A (no-tech), you run the calendar in a Google Sheet with conditional-format highlighting.

The nurture content library

Nurture touches are not "just checking in." Every nurture touch should pair a value point with a soft ask. Build a library of nurture content pieces you rotate through:

1. **Market update** — "Rates/premiums/prices did X this quarter"
2. **Common mistake** — "Here's the #1 thing folks who shopped [vertical] 6 months ago regret"
3. **Case study** — "Worked with someone last week in a similar spot — here's how it came out"
4. **Question** — "What's the one thing that would make you ready to look at this again?"
5. **Tool/resource** — "Built a simple calculator for [X] — free, thought you might find it useful"
6. **Seasonal** — Q4 planning, year-end tax, spring shopping, whatever fits your vertical

Rotate through the library so nurture doesn't feel repetitive. A 6-piece library fills 18 months of nurture touches without repetition.

Worksheet 6 — Nurture Calendar. In your workbook, map your current lead base to the three buckets and schedule the first 90 days of nurture touches.

Part VI — Compliance Foundation

This is the shortest part of the playbook and the most important. Skip compliance and you will lose your operation — not to the market, to the regulator.

I am not a lawyer. This is operator guidance, not legal advice. When you have a real question, the firm I trust is Henson Legal — they're the TCPA specialists I call. Budget for a 30-minute intro consult before you run your first campaign. It will be the best $300–$500 you spend on this operation.

The non-negotiables

1. DNC scrubbing — every file, every time

Before any outreach fires, every phone number in your list must be scrubbed against:

- The national DNC registry
- Any state-specific DNC lists applicable to your outreach (several states maintain their own)
- Your internal suppression list (anyone who has asked you to stop)
- The lead publisher's suppression list (if provided)

Scrub cost runs $0.005–$0.02 per number at volume. For a 1,000-lead batch, that's $5–$20. Skip it and the downside is $500–$1,500+ in statutory damages per violation, per call. Do not be clever about this.

2. Consent documentation — keep the record

For every lead, you should be able to produce, on demand:

- The original form the consumer filled out
- The exact consent language they agreed to
- The date/time/IP of the submission
- The source publisher who sold you the data

Reputable aged-lead publishers provide this in a "trusted form certificate" or equivalent. If your publisher won't provide it, shop elsewhere.

On the 1-to-1 consent rule (as of 2026). The FCC's proposed rule that would have required consent to name each specific caller (the "one-to-one" rule) was **vacated by the 11th Circuit in January 2025** (*Insurance Marketing Coalition v. FCC*) and formally repealed by the FCC in August 2025. The earlier "prior express written consent" (PEWC) standard is back in force — which is less prescriptive about buyer-naming, but still requires clear, unambiguous consent for autodialed or prerecorded calls/texts.

What this means practically: inherited aged-lead consent is still workable for manual dial and email. It is **weaker ground for autodialed calls, prerecorded voice, RVM, and automated SMS.** The safest strategy is to *use the aged-lead cadence to earn fresh PEWC directly from each prospect* (see the Fresh-Consent Ladder in Part IV), and run your higher-intensity channels only on fresh-consent records.

3. SMS compliance — 10DLC, opt-out, and hours

- Your SMS sending numbers should be registered with your carrier as 10DLC (10-digit-long-code) with a business profile. Unregistered numbers get blocked and may create carrier-terms-of-service problems.
- Every SMS message — especially the first touch — should include an opt-out mechanism ("Reply STOP to opt out").
- Honor opt-outs immediately. When someone replies STOP, your system should add them to suppression in real time across all channels.
- Federal SMS time windows: 8 AM–9 PM in the **prospect's** local time zone. **Several states cap earlier at 8 PM** — FL, OK, WA, MD, AL, CT, LA, MA, MS, WY.
- **On aged leads specifically:** running automated SMS on inherited consent alone is a higher-risk posture. The conservative approach is Fresh-Consent Ladder Play 2 (text-to-join keyword) — get the prospect to initiate the SMS relationship.

4. Call time windows

The federal TCPA allows calls 8 AM–9 PM in the prospect's local time zone. **Several state mini-TCPAs cap earlier at 8 PM** (see list above). Know your prospect's time zone — infer from area code, confirm with address where available.

State frequency caps:

- **Florida FTSA and Oklahoma OTSA:** no more than **3 calls or texts per 24-hour period on the same subject.** Going over the cap is a statutory violation.
- **Washington HB 1497:** the caller must identify themselves, their company, and the purpose within the first 30 seconds of the call. Must end the call within 10 seconds of the called party

requesting to end it.

Texas updated its telemarketing rules in August 2025 — check current state of play before running Texas lists.

5. Autodialer, predictive dialer, and prerecorded rules

TCPA requires **Prior Express Written Consent (PEWC)** for autodialed or prerecorded calls/texts to cell phones. On aged leads, inherited consent rarely supports this cleanly.

- **Predictive and parallel dialers to cell phones on aged lists:** do not run without a PEWC record from each prospect that explicitly covers automated calls. This is a Mode C tactic in this context.
- **Preview dialers (one-at-a-time, agent-initiated):** generally fine. This is the Mode B default.
- **Ringless voicemail (RVM):** the FCC ruled in November 2022 that RVM to wireless is a "call" under the TCPA and requires consent. **Do not run RVM at scale on inherited aged-lead consent.** It is the fastest way to collect a TCPA demand letter in this vertical.
- **Prerecorded voice calls:** same rules as RVM — require PEWC to cells.

The operating rule: manual or preview dial only, unless your consent workflow produces fresh PEWC directly from each prospect (Fresh-Consent Ladder, Part IV).

6. State-specific rules (as of 2026)

State mini-TCPAs layer on top of federal. The meaningful ones:

State	Framework	Key provisions
Florida (FTSA)	§501.059 + §501.616	PEWC required for automated outreach; 3-calls/day cap; 8 AM–8 PM; $500/call statutory
Oklahoma (OTSA)	eff. Nov 2022	Modeled on FTSA; 3 calls/day; 8 AM–8 PM
Washington (HB 1497)	in force	30-second ID rule; 10-second hang-up rule
Maryland	mini-TCPA	Stricter consent + 8 PM cap
Texas	Updated Aug 2025	Check current state; was historically less strict
California	CCPA/CPRA	Data-handling obligations (not outreach-specific)

If you buy leads in these states, scrub against state DNC, honor state caps, and document consent in the form the state requires. When in doubt, call Henson Legal.

7. Coming in 2027 — revocation-all rule

The FCC's "revocation-all" rule — which requires a single opt-out to apply across all unrelated calls and texts from the same sender — was scheduled for 2026 but has been delayed to **January 31, 2027.** Start building opt-out-propagation infrastructure now so you're ready.

The compliance stack — minimum viable

For Mode A (Conservative):

- DNC scrubber (manual batch): DNC.com, PossibleNOW, or Gryphon — $0.005–$0.02 per number
- Google Sheet suppression list with a dedicated tab
- Henson Legal on call: budget $300–$500 for an initial consult, $200–$400/hour as-needed
- Fresh-Consent Ladder (Part IV) infrastructure — a landing page with PEWC form + 10DLC SMS keyword

For Mode B (Operator Standard):

- All of the above, plus integrated DNC scrubbing in your CRM (HubSpot, Close, GoHighLevel connectors)
- Call recording with "this call may be recorded" disclosure where required
- Automated cross-channel opt-out propagation
- Quarterly compliance audit (Worksheet 8) plus one annual counsel review

The audit cadence

Once a month, audit your operation:

1. Random-sample 10 outreach records. For each: confirm the consent record is on file, confirm DNC scrub happened, confirm suppression check happened, confirm no outreach outside call-time window.
2. Review all opt-outs from the prior month. Confirm each has been suppressed across all channels.
3. Review your DNC scrubber invoice. Confirm every list you outreached got scrubbed.
4. Spot-check SMS records for 10DLC registration status and opt-out inclusion.

Document the audit in a log. When — not if — you get a demand letter, your documented audit history is evidence of good-faith compliance and is very hard to penetrate.

> **Worksheet 8 — Compliance Self-Audit.** In your workbook, run the first month's audit using the checklist provided.

Part VII — The 90-Day Operator Diagnostic

You've read the playbook. Now let's find out where your operation actually stands.

This diagnostic has 25 questions across 5 dimensions. Score each question 0–4 (0 = not doing this at all, 4 = doing this consistently and well). Total score out of 100.

Dimension 1: Unit economics (20 points)

1. I know my current ARPC within $50 of accuracy. (0–4)
2. I know my current contact rate per lead source. (0–4)
3. I know my current contact-to-close rate. (0–4)
4. I compute my max viable CPL before every lead purchase. (0–4)
5. I review my unit economics at least monthly. (0–4)

Dimension 2: Operation setup (20 points)

6. I have a defined tech stack matched to my volume. (0–4)
7. I have named the 5 operational roles and know who owns each. (0–4)
8. I have a documented lead-intake process (scrub, segment, tag). (0–4)
9. I have a CRM or sheet that tracks every touch with every lead. (0–4)
10. I know what my bottleneck is right now. (0–4)

Dimension 3: Outreach discipline (20 points)

11. I run a defined multi-channel 14-day opener cadence. (0–4)
12. My scripts are written down and refreshed quarterly. (0–4)
13. I log every touch with outcome. (0–4)
14. I vary call times and days to improve contact rate. (0–4)
15. My break-up touches are as intentional as my first touches. (0–4)

Dimension 4: Nurture (20 points)

16. I have a 30/60/90/180/365-day nurture calendar. (0–4)
17. I classify every non-closed lead into Warm/Cold/Dormant. (0–4)

18. I have a library of 6+ nurture content pieces I rotate through. (0–4)
19. I track re-engagement rate on nurture touches. (0–4)
20. I have closed at least one deal from a 90+ day old lead in the last quarter. (0–4)

Dimension 5: Compliance (20 points)

21. I scrub every list against DNC before outreach. (0–4)
22. I have consent documentation archived for every lead in my system. (0–4)
23. My SMS operation is 10DLC-registered with opt-out on every message. (0–4)
24. I honor opt-outs within 24 hours across all channels. (0–4)
25. I run a monthly compliance audit and document it. (0–4)

Scoring

- **85–100:** You are running at an operator level. Focus on marginal optimization.
- **65–84:** You have the basics right. Focus on your lowest-scoring dimension.
- **40–64:** Workable but leaking. Pick the two dimensions with the lowest scores and fix those this quarter.
- **Below 40:** You are running on feel. Stop buying leads until you install the basics. You're losing money on every purchase.

> **Worksheet 10 — Operator Diagnostic.** In your workbook, complete the 25-question diagnostic and identify your top 2 weak dimensions.

Next moves

You now have the system. The difference between operators who succeed with aged leads and those who don't is not knowledge — it's execution.

Here's what to do this week:

1. **Fill out the workbook.** All 10 worksheets. It will take 90 minutes. Do it once, reference it forever.
2. **Score yourself on the diagnostic.** Be honest. The diagnostic is only useful if you're honest about where you are today.

3. **Pick one dimension to fix in the next 30 days.** Not five. One. Usually it's either the unit economics (you don't know your numbers) or the outreach cadence (you're not following one).
4. **Find a lead source.** When you're ready to buy, **agedleadstore.com** offers aged leads across all the major verticals with consent documentation and suppression support. Start with the smallest batch they offer, run it through your new system, and measure.
5. **Get on the weekly list.** The Work Aged Leads weekly newsletter ships every Tuesday with one tactical idea to sharpen your operation. You're already on the list (that's how you got this playbook). Open every one — they're short.

You have the system. Go run it.

— Bill

The Aged Lead Operator's System is published by Work Aged Leads. For corrections, updates, or to request a vertical-specific consultation, visit workagedleads.com/contact.

Home Services Overlay

Home Services Overlay — Aged Home Services Leads

Companion to The Aged Lead Operator's System. Read the master playbook first.

This overlay covers aged leads in home services: roofing, solar, windows, HVAC, kitchen/bath remodel, pest control, foundation, and related trades. The dynamics are different from financial-services leads — the prospect usually has a physical asset (the house) with a problem that doesn't go away on its own.

> **Compliance mode reminder.** Default to Mode A for inherited aged-lead consent: manual dial, plain-text email, fresh-consent ladder. Home services has heavy TCPA plaintiff-firm activity, plus state-specific storm-moratorium and contractor-solicitation rules. Until your consent workflow is tight, **stay in Mode A.** Use Fresh-Consent Ladder plays to graduate specific prospects to Mode B.
>
> **Recommended counsel:** Henson Legal for TCPA and state solicitation questions. Pair with a state-licensed contractor-board attorney if you operate in a state with strict contractor marketing rules.

Vertical benchmarks (by sub-vertical)

Sub-vertical	Realistic CPL (60–180d)	Contact rate	Contact-to-appointment	Appt-to-sold	ARPC (net revenue)
Roofing	$1.00–$6.00	12–20%	15–25%	20–35%	$2,500–$8,000
Solar	$2.00–$10.00	10–18%	10–18%	15–25%	$3,000–$8,000
Windows	$0.75–$4.00	12–20%	12–22%	15–30%	$2,000–$5,000
HVAC install	$1.00–$5.00	14–22%	18–28%	25–40%	$1,500–$5,000
Kitchen/bath	$1.00–$4.00	10–16%	10–18%	15–25%	$8,000–$25,000
Pest control	$0.50–$2.00	15–25%	30–40%	40–60%	$200–$600 (annual)
Foundation	$1.00–$4.00	12–18%	20–30%	25–40%	$5,000–$20,000

Two-step funnel. Home services is the one vertical where contact-to-close is almost always a two-step funnel: contact → appointment (in-home or virtual estimate) → sold. Your scripts need to optimize for *booking the estimate*, not closing on the call.

Break-even math example — roofing. $4,500 ARPC, 15% contact rate, 20% contact-to-appointment, 30% appointment-to-sold, 4× target return:

```
Contact-to-sold = 20% × 30% = 6%
Max CPL = $4,500 × 0.25 × 0.15 × 0.06 = $10.13
```

Home services can tolerate higher CPLs than most verticals because ARPCs are higher and the estimate step produces strong closing rates in the hands of a good field rep.

Where to source aged home-services leads.

AgedLeadStore offers aged roofing, solar, windows, HVAC, remodel, and pest leads — filterable by geography and project type, with consent records included.

Shop aged home services leads →

Sub-vertical playbooks

Roofing

Prospect intent: storm damage, age replacement, insurance claim support.

The 3-month-later pitch: roofing leads often shopped *because* a storm rolled through. 3 months later, many have discovered the damage was worse than they thought, or their insurance claim stalled. Open with: "Did you end up getting the roof handled, or is your insurance still dragging?"

Seasonal note: roofing has strong seasonality. Spring/early summer is peak. Aged leads from fall are often your best buy — they didn't close before winter, and now spring is their window.

Supplement vs. replace. Many aged roofing leads are repair/supplement prospects (roof is old but not ready to replace). Run a longer nurture on these — their replacement timer is 1–3 years out.

Solar

Prospect intent: utility bill reduction, tax credit, eco-values, home resale value.

The 3-month-later pitch: solar economics have shifted rapidly as utility rates, panel prices, and the ITC have all moved. A prospect who shopped 3+ months ago got one set of numbers; today's numbers are often meaningfully different. Open with: "Have you seen what your utility bill's done since you looked at solar last?"

Sub-segments:

- High utility-cost states (CA, HI, NY, NJ, MA) — strongest economics
- Recently-moved homeowners — have cleared the initial "settle in" phase and are now ready for big projects
- Backyard battery / backup shoppers — different product, different close

Lead-quality caution. Solar has the widest variance in aged-lead quality. Cheaper solar lead files are often heavily over-sold and have low contact rates. Buy smaller batches first; measure contact rate; size up only if it beats 10%.

Windows

Prospect intent: energy efficiency, aesthetic upgrade, noise, storm prep.

The 3-month-later pitch: windows are often a "someday" project that gets deferred for budget reasons. Financing and seasonal promos are your pitch. "Interest rates on financing moved — worth revisiting what you looked at back in [month]."

Whole-home vs. partial. Most aged window leads are partial-replacement shoppers (3–5 windows). The upsell to whole-home is where ARPC doubles. Your estimate script should diagnose whole-home need.

HVAC (install)

Prospect intent: replacement urgency (current system failing), energy-efficiency upgrade, home sale prep.

The 3-month-later pitch: HVAC often doesn't wait. If a prospect shopped for a new system 3+ months ago and didn't buy, either they got it handled or their current system is limping along. Direct probe: "Did you end up replacing the system, or is it still the original?"

Seasonal note: HVAC is hottest during the vertical's stress season (summer for AC, winter for heat). An aged lead from last summer shopping AC is prime pre-season bait heading into this summer.

Kitchen / bath remodel

Prospect intent: lifestyle upgrade, home sale prep, long-planned project.

The 3-month-later pitch: remodels are the longest-cycle home-services project. Aged leads routinely convert 6–18 months after their original inquiry. This sub-vertical has the highest *nurture* value and the lowest *opener* urgency. Plan accordingly — don't burn budget trying to close on Day 1.

Sub-segments:

- Kitchen-only (faster decision, lower ARPC)
- Whole-house / addition (longer cycle, higher ARPC)
- Accessibility remodels (aging-in-place, often insurance-funded)

Pest control

Prospect intent: acute pest issue, preventive / seasonal, termite inspection.

The 3-month-later pitch: pest problems don't age gracefully. A prospect who shopped pest control 3 months ago and didn't buy either (a) DIY'd it and now has a worse problem, or (b) used a competitor who isn't keeping up. Fast, direct opener: "Did the pest issue get handled, or is it still going?"

This sub-vertical has the highest contact rate and best close rate in the overlay — because the problem doesn't wait.

Foundation

Prospect intent: acute structural concern, pre-sale repair, insurance-covered damage.

The 3-month-later pitch: foundation issues get worse over time. A prospect who got quotes 3 months ago and hasn't moved is probably (a) trying to decide between providers, (b) waiting on insurance, or (c) procrastinating on bad news. Direct, empathetic script works: "I know foundation stuff is nobody's favorite project — did you end up getting it started, or is it still on the list?"

Home-services-specific scripts

Script HA1 — First-touch call (roofing)

> "Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. A couple months back you looked at getting quotes on your roof — just checking in to see if you got it handled, or if your insurance is still dragging on the claim."

Script HA2 — First-touch call (solar)

> "Hey [Name], this is [Your Name] with [Company]. You looked at solar quotes back in [month] — what happened with that? Did you end up pulling the trigger, or is it still on the list?"

If still exploring: "Numbers have moved a lot since you last looked — utility rates are up about [current % vs shop date], which changes the payback period meaningfully. Want me to run fresh

numbers on your address real quick?"

Script HA3 — First-touch call (windows, financing hook)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. You got window quotes back in [month] — we're running some financing specials heading into [season], and I wanted to see if windows are still on your list before we run out of slots for [season]."

The financing / slot-scarcity hook works well in home services because it's true — most contractors legitimately have seasonal schedules and financing terms that move.

Script HA4 — First-touch call (HVAC, pre-season)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. You looked at HVAC replacement back in [month] — with [season] coming up, I wanted to see if you got the system replaced or if you're still limping along with the old one."

Script HA5 — First-touch call (kitchen/bath)

> "Hey [Name], [Your Name] with [Company]. You were looking at kitchen/bath remodel back in [month] — long project cycle on those, totally get it. Just wanted to check in and see where you landed — are you still in planning mode, or did you move forward with someone?"

Soft tone. Remodel prospects are almost always deliberating, and an aggressive opener will close the door.

Script HA6 — Voicemail (generic home services)

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Calling about the [roofing / solar / windows / HVAC / etc.] question you had back in [month]. Wanted to see if you got it handled or if you still need a fresh look. Give me a ring at [number] or I'll try you in a couple days."

Home services objection library

"I already hired someone." → "Nice — who'd you end up going with? Any hiccups?" Two purposes: competitive intel, and if the project had problems, you're the rescue call. Add to Cold nurture with a 6-month refresh touch.

"I decided not to do it." → "Fair — what made you pull back? Was it the quote, timing, or just the project itself?" Diagnose. If it was quote-only, you have a re-engagement opportunity once financing/pricing shifts.

"Send me a quote." → "I'd love to, but for [roofing/solar/windows/HVAC] it's really hard to give you a useful number without putting eyes on the house. Can we get 30 minutes on the calendar for an estimate? Free, no pressure, and you get a real number instead of a guess."

"Just looking, not ready to buy." → "Totally fine — a lot of our best customers started in just-looking mode. When you're thinking of pulling the trigger — this year, next year, further out?" Map their timeline. That's your nurture anchor.

Home services SMS scripts

Script HS1 — Roofing, value-first

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Roofing rates have moved since you shopped back in [month]. Storm damage claims have also gotten faster to process. Want me to pull fresh numbers on your roof? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script HS2 — Solar, payback hook

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Quick note: utility rates in [state] are up ~[%] this year. Solar payback period has shortened for most folks. Want me to run the numbers on your address? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script HS3 — Windows, financing

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Running a financing special on windows this month — thinking of you since you got quotes back in [month]. Worth a 2-min look? Reply STOP to opt out."

Script HS4 — HVAC, seasonal

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Heading into [summer/winter], appointment slots for HVAC install fill up fast. Since you were looking back in [month], wanted to get you on the schedule if you're still interested. Reply STOP to opt out."

Script HS5 — Remodel, soft touch

> "Hey [Name] — [Your Name] with [Company]. Just checking in on your [kitchen/bath] remodel project. No rush — let me know when you want to pick it back up. Reply STOP to opt out."

Home services email scripts

Script HE1 — Day 2 opener (roofing)

Subject: Your roof quote from [month]

Hey [Name],

Back in [month] you looked at getting your roof handled. Following up because your inquiry ended up on my desk.

Couple things worth checking:

1. Did the insurance claim close, if there was one?
2. Has the damage gotten worse with [last relevant storm event or winter/summer]?
3. Are you planning to replace before [next insurance renewal / home sale / etc.]?

If any of those are still open, I can have someone out for a free estimate in the next 2 weeks. Reply with your availability and I'll send a confirmation.

— Bill

Script HE2 — Day 5 (solar, math refresh)

Subject: Solar payback math — updated for [year]

[Name] —

Since you looked at solar in [month], three things moved:

1. Utility rates in [state] are up roughly [%]
2. Panel pricing is down about [%] from supply-chain normalization
3. The ITC [current status — 30%, stepping down, etc.]

Net effect: most people's payback period has shortened by [X years] since last spring. Want me to run the updated numbers for your specific address? Takes about 5 minutes once I have your utility bill.

— Bill

Script HE3 — Day 5 (windows, financing)

Subject: One last thing on your window project

[Name] —

Quick note: we've got a [specific financing offer — 0% for X months, low APR, whatever's current] promo running through [end date]. For a full-home window project, that typically saves our customers $[range] over the life of the financing vs. cash-out refi or credit card.

If windows are still on your list, want me to get you on the schedule for a no-pressure estimate? We can get the numbers together and you can decide whether to use the promo or wait.

— Bill

Script HE4 — Day 10 break-up (any home services)

Subject: Closing out your [project] file

[Name] —

I've reached out a few times on your [project] project — haven't caught you. I'll close my file for now.

If the timing is off, totally understand — reply any time and I'll pick it back up. Otherwise, good luck with the project whenever you get to it.

— Bill

Load your field calendar.

The scripts above are built around booking estimates, not closing on the phone. To keep your field reps busy, most home-services operators rotate through 250–750 aged leads per rep per month.

Browse home services leads by type →

Compliance notes specific to home services

TCPA — no different, but enforcement is aggressive

Home services is one of the most-TCPA-targeted verticals for both consumer complaints and plaintiff's-firm surveillance. Treat every number as if a TCPA plaintiff might be on the other end.

- Scrub every number against federal DNC. Every time. Scrub state DNC where applicable.
- Document your consent record per lead.
- SMS 10DLC registration — required.
- **No predictive or parallel dialing on inherited aged-lead consent.** Preview dial only.
- **No ringless voicemail.** FCC ruled November 2022 that RVM to wireless is a "call" under TCPA.
- On the 1:1 rule: the FCC's proposed 1-to-1 consent rule was vacated by the 11th Circuit (Jan 2025) and repealed by the FCC (Aug 2025). PEWC is the live standard. Inherited consent workable for manual outreach; weak for automation — use Fresh-Consent Ladder to escalate.

Home-services-specific fresh-consent plays

Home services has the strongest fresh-consent capture on the front end because the prospect already wants a physical outcome — they just need a reason to raise their hand:

1. **Free estimate booking form** — the highest-converting fresh-consent moment. Gate every estimate booking behind a form with an explicit PEWC checkbox. Almost everyone who gets to the form wants the estimate and will check the box.
2. **Storm-damage photo upload** — for roofing especially. A landing page that lets the prospect upload photos of their roof for a preliminary evaluation. Form captures fresh PEWC + produces a visual lead asset.
3. **Neighborhood-project text opt-in** — "Text [zip code] to [number] to hear when we're in your neighborhood" — great local, geo-targeted fresh consent.
4. **Financing pre-qualification** — "Text QUAL to [number] for a soft-pull pre-qualification on financing for your project." Hot-intent, fresh PEWC capture.
5. **Seasonal maintenance reminder opt-in** — "Text REMIND to [number] for quarterly home-maintenance reminders." Low-intent, but long-tail nurture asset.

State-specific contractor / solicitation rules

Many states have specific rules on home-services solicitation:

- **California** — CSLB rules on contractor marketing, plus specific solar solicitation requirements.

- **Florida** — post-storm moratorium rules prohibit unsolicited contact after declared disasters.
- **Texas** — specific rules on roofing solicitation.
- **Many states** — "gift for appointment" restrictions limit how you can incentivize estimate bookings.

Know your states. Your sales rep who promises a $100 gift card for scheduling an appointment may be violating state solicitation law without knowing it.

Storm-chasing restrictions

Post-storm, several states temporarily restrict solicitation for roofing and related trades. The purpose is consumer protection — to prevent fly-by-night storm chasers. If you're running aged leads in a state after a major weather event, pause the outreach and verify you're not in a moratorium window.

"Free inspection" language

Offering a "free inspection" sounds benign, but some state contractor boards treat it as a regulated solicitation. Language like "free estimate" is generally safer than "free inspection" because it implies a sales-qualification interaction rather than a diagnostic claim.

Financing disclosures

If you promote financing in your outreach (SMS, email, calls), you may trigger Regulation Z disclosure requirements (APR, terms, fees). "0% financing" mentioned on a cold call without the full disclosure behind it is a compliance risk. Work with your financing partner to build compliant script language.

Door-to-door overlap

Home-services teams often pair aged-lead outreach with door-to-door follow-up on unreached prospects. D2D has its own compliance layer:

- Local permits required in many municipalities
- "No soliciting" signs must be honored
- Federal cooling-off rule (3-day right to cancel on in-home sales over $25)

> **When in doubt:** Henson Legal. They'll flag state-specific contractor, storm, and solicitation rules that matter for your operation.

Home-services-specific nurture content

Build your nurture library around the project lifecycle:

Pre-project:

- Seasonal home-maintenance checklists
- Financing market updates
- Material-cost trend updates (lumber, steel, copper, panel prices)
- "What to know before you hire" buyer's guides

Post-close (customer) but aged-lead-style:

- Maintenance reminders (roofing inspection, HVAC service, window caulking)
- Warranty check-ins
- Upsell nurture for related projects

Event-triggered:

- Post-storm outreach (weather-appropriate, and compliant with state rules)
- Post-utility-rate-change (solar, windows)
- Post-neighborhood-activity (we did X houses on your street — want us to look at yours?)

The "neighborhood" nurture angle

Home services gets a unique nurture angle that other verticals don't: local proof. Map your aged leads by zip. When you book a job in a zip code, send a soft touch to every aged lead in that zip: "Hey, we're doing a [project] around the corner from you at [street name] — want me to swing by while we're in the neighborhood and give you a fresh estimate?" This is one of the highest-ROI nurture plays in home services.

Your home-services operator quick-check

- [ ] Appointment-booking workflow in place (calendar, routing, confirmation)
- [ ] Field-rep capacity confirmed for your expected booking rate
- [ ] Sub-vertical-specific CPL budgets calculated (they differ widely)
- [ ] State contractor / solicitation rules confirmed for your working states

- [ ] Storm-response protocol documented (where applicable)
- [ ] Financing partner compliance language reviewed
- [ ] Neighborhood-mapping set up in CRM (by zip/route)
- [ ] SMS 10DLC registration confirmed
- [ ] "Free estimate" language (not "free inspection") in all scripts
- [ ] Door-to-door compliance (if applicable) documented

You're ready. Go.

Your first batch.

Start with a tight geographic radius — one or two zip-code clusters — so your field reps aren't driving past each other. 250–500 aged leads per rep per month is usually the right opening volume.

Browse aged home services leads →
